



Azad was appointed president of the Congress party in 1940. Both before and after 1940, he was arrested several times for his involvement in the nationalist movement.

Educating India

In post-Independence India, Azad had new challenges to face. As India's first education minister, he had a monumental job ahead: about 85 per cent of Indians were illiterate since education had historically been denied to the vast majority of women, the poor and those considered lower caste. Azad now set out to right these wrongs. His policy recommendations included free, universal and compulsory basic education for children, adult education